



30 percent of the state's population and existing by **hunting**, fishing, and growing rice in the thick jungle. **Sarawak** is known as "the land of the hornbill" after a majestic bird believed by the Iban people to be a

messenger from the spirit world. Today, the majority of the Iban are Christian, but they still practice **traditional** rituals, which are a mixture of animistic and **Hindu-Buddhist** beliefs.

## Hunting

The Iban hunt and eat a wide variety of forest animals, including birds, squirrels, monkeys, lizards, and barking deer. But the most prized game animal is the bearded pig. Sometimes weighing more than 220 lb (100 kg), one of these animals can supply enough meat to feed a group for several days.



### BLOWPIPES

The traditional hunting weapon of the Iban is the blowpipe. It is lighter and more accurate than a shotgun and the darts kill silently, allowing a hunter take a second shot should he miss the first. The darts are dipped in poison made from tree sap, which kills by causing suffocation. The dose is carefully chosen to suit the prey.

To shoot the dart fast and accurately, the breath must be blown from the chest and stomach rather than just the mouth.

### HEADHUNTERS

As recently as 50 years ago the Iban people were notorious headhunters. They believed that the captured heads of their enemies would bring them strength and prosperity. It is now illegal to headhunt in Sarawak.



### LONGBOATS

The Iban travel on the rivers and waterways in longboats. They are not only for transportation, but also to show off the owner's carving skills and status among the villagers. Well-carved paddles are also used for ceremonial occasions.

